

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Foreign Trade, WTO, FTAs and Protectionism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Foreign Trade, WTO, FTAs and Protectionism REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
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03 FOUNDATION — TARIFFS AND VALUE-CHAIN INCIDENCE Technically, FOUNDATION — Tariffs and value-chain incidence is	04 CORE — NON-TARIFF MEASURES WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade
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Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Trade-policy transmission?

A. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. B. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. C. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. D. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive.

Answer: A. Explanation: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Trade-policy transmission?

A. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. B. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. C. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. D. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.

Answer: B. Explanation: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses Trade-policy transmission without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. B. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. C. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. D. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation.

Answer: C. Explanation: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Trade-policy transmission?

A. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. B. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. C. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. D. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Merchandise and services boundary?

A. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. B. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. C. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. D. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive.

Answer: A. Explanation: Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Merchandise and services boundary?

A. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. B. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. C. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. D. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses Merchandise and services boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. B. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. C. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. D. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding.

Answer: C. Explanation: Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions

or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Merchandise and services boundary?

A. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. B. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. C. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. D. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account.

Answer: D. Explanation: Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Tariff boundary?

A. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. B. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. C. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. D. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive.

Answer: A. Explanation: A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Tariff boundary?

A. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. B. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. C. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. D. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions.

Answer: B. Explanation: A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Tariff boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. B. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. C. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. D. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Answer: C. Explanation: A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Tariff boundary?

A. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. B. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. C. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. D. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.

Answer: D. Explanation: A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Non-tariff measure boundary?

A. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. B. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. C. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. D. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation.

Answer: A. Explanation: A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Non-tariff measure boundary?

A. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. B. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. C. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. D. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Answer: B. Explanation: A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Non-tariff measure boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. B. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. C. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. D. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself.

Answer: C. Explanation: A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Non-tariff measure boundary?

A. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. B. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. C. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. D. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive.

Answer: D. Explanation: A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies MFN treatment?

A. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. B. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. C. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. D. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation.

Answer: A. Explanation: WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of MFN treatment?

A. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. B. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. C. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. D. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself.

Answer: B. Explanation: WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses MFN treatment without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. B. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. C. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. D. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner.

Answer: C. Explanation: WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MFN treatment?

A. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. B. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. C. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. D. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions.

Answer: D. Explanation: WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies National treatment?

A. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. B. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. C. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. D. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding.

Answer: A. Explanation: WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of National treatment?

A. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. B. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. C. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. D. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself.

Answer: B. Explanation: WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses National treatment without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. B. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. C. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. D. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself.

Answer: C. Explanation: WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about National treatment?

A. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. B. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. C. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. D. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation.

Answer: D. Explanation: WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Bound and applied tariffs?

A. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. B. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. C. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. D. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Answer: A. Explanation: A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Bound and applied tariffs?

A. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. B. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. C. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. D. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner.

Answer: B. Explanation: A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses Bound and applied tariffs without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. B. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. C. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. D. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.

Answer: C. Explanation: A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Bound and applied tariffs?

A. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. B. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. C. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. D. A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding.

Answer: D. Explanation: A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies FTA legal and status boundary?

A. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. B. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. C. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. D. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner.

Answer: A. Explanation: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of FTA legal and status boundary?

A. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. B. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. C. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. D. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.

Answer: B. Explanation: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses FTA legal and status boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. B. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. C. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. D. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.

Answer: C. Explanation: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about FTA legal and status boundary?

A. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. B. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. C. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. D. An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Answer: D. Explanation: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Rules of origin?

A. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. B. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. C. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. D. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Rules of origin?

A. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. B. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. C. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. D. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses Rules of origin without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. B. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. C. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. D. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Rules of origin?

A. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. B. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. C. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. D. Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Trade creation and diversion?

A. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. B. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. C. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. D. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.

Answer: A. Explanation: Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Trade creation and diversion?

A. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. B. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. C. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. D. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses Trade creation and diversion without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. B. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. C. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. D. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Trade creation and diversion?

A. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. B. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. C. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. D. Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner.

Answer: D. Explanation: Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Trade-remedy categories?

A. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. B. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. C. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. D. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty.

Answer: A. Explanation: Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Trade-remedy categories?

A. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. B. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. C. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. D. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses Trade-remedy categories without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. B. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. C. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. D. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Trade-remedy categories?

A. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. B. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. C. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. D. Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.

Answer: D. Explanation: Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies DGTR and notification boundary?

A. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. B. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. C. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. D. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of DGTR and notification boundary?

A. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. B. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. C. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. D. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q47. Which statement uses DGTR and notification boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. B. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. C. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. D. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about DGTR and notification boundary?

A. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. B. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. C. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. D. The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies TRIMS scope?

A. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. B. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. C. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. D. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain.

Answer: A. Explanation: The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of TRIMS scope?

A. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. B. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. C. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. D. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses TRIMS scope without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. B. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. C. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. D. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about TRIMS scope?

A. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. B. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. C. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. D. The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The WTO Agreement on Trade-Related Investment Measures concerns goods-related measures inconsistent with GATT disciplines, including local-content and trade-balancing requirements; it is not a general investment treaty. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies TRIPS and domestic rights?

A. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. B. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. C. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. D. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation.

Answer: A. Explanation: TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of TRIPS and domestic rights?

A. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. B. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. C. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. D. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain.

Answer: B. Explanation: TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses TRIPS and domestic rights without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. B. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. C. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. D. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement.

Answer: C. Explanation: TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about TRIPS and domestic rights?

A. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. B. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. C. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. D. TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law.

Answer: D. Explanation: TRIPS sets minimum intellectual-property standards, while grant, validity, enforcement and commercialisation of a patent or geographical indication remain governed through domestic institutions and law. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies International Grains Council?

A. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. B. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. C. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. D. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of International Grains Council?

A. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. B. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. C. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. D. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses International Grains Council without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. B. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. C. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. D. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Answer: C. Explanation: The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about International Grains Council?

A. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. B. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. C. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. D. The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The International Grains Council is an intergovernmental grain-trade and market-transparency body, not a UN relief agency, domestic procurement authority or price-setting organisation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Protection and downstream competitiveness?

A. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. B. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. C. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. D. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Answer: A. Explanation: Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Protection and downstream competitiveness?

A. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. B. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. C. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. D. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection.

Answer: B. Explanation: Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses Protection and downstream competitiveness without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. B. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. C. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. D. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Answer: C. Explanation: Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Protection and downstream competitiveness?

A. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. B. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. C. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. D. Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain.

Answer: D. Explanation: Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies GVC capability conditions?

A. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. B. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. C. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. D. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection.

Answer: A. Explanation: Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of GVC capability conditions?

A. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. B. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. C. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. D. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Answer: B. Explanation: Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses GVC capability conditions without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. B. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. C. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. D. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account.

Answer: C. Explanation: Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about GVC capability conditions?

A. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. B. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. C. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. D. Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies WTO dispute-settlement status?

A. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. B. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. C. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. D. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of WTO dispute-settlement status?

A. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. B. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. C. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. D. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses WTO dispute-settlement status without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. B. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. C. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. D. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.

Answer: C. Explanation: The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about WTO dispute-settlement status?

A. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. B. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. C. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. D. The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Public stockholding boundary?

A. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. B. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. C. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. D. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Public stockholding boundary?

A. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. B. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. C. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. D. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account.

Answer: B. Explanation: WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Public stockholding boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. B. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. C. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. D. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.

Answer: C. Explanation: WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Public stockholding boundary?

A. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. B. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. C. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. D. WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Answer: D. Explanation: WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Resilience versus autarky?

A. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. B. A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. C. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. D. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account.

Answer: A. Explanation: Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Resilience versus autarky?

A. Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. B. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. C. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. D. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.

Answer: B. Explanation: Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Resilience versus autarky without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. B. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. C. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. D. A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.

Answer: C. Explanation: Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Resilience versus autarky?

A. A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. B. WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. C. WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. D. Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection.

Answer: D. Explanation: Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route the 2018 and 2025 GS-III protectionism demands and objective demands on edible oils, geographical indications, merchandise/services trade, TRIMS, the International Grains Council and apple/GM-food distinctions. Objective answer letters are not reproduced or inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2025 GS-III: Challenges as the world shifts from multilateral free trade to protectionism and bilateralism.
- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Intellectual-property rights in life materials and the gap between patent filing and commercialisation.
- ANALYSIS: 2026 Prelims provisional key links certification and port logistics to premium-market access and trade competitiveness.
- ANALYSIS: **IPR answer route:** distinguish TRIPS minimum standards from domestic innovation systems; explain commercialisation through research quality, technology transfer, finance, regulatory pathways, market discovery, skills and risk appetite rather than patent counts alone.
- ANALYSIS: **CBAM route:** if the question raises climate-linked trade barriers, cite the EU CBAM's definitive-regime start (1 January 2026), its six covered sectors, India's WTO-consistency/CBDR objections, and the limitation that exposure varies with embedded emissions and the EU ETS price; cross-refer Topic 25 for India's own domestic decarbonisation/MRV response.
- ANALYSIS: **2024 Prelims Q92 route:** India's apple imports from the USA and the GM-food import-approval requirement (GEAC/FSSAI) are two independent statements; state each fact on its own terms and its limitation, without inferring one from the other or naming an answer option.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "9. PYQ application", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in "9. PYQ application".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2025 GS-III: Challenges as the world shifts from multilateral free trade to **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Intellectual-property rights in life materials and the gap between **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2026 Prelims provisional key links certification and port logistics to premium-market **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: IPR answer route: distinguish TRIPS minimum standards from domestic innovation **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price,

quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** systems; explain commercialisation through research quality, technology transfer, **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** finance, regulatory pathways, market discovery, skills and risk appetite rather than **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in “9. PYQ application”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “9. PYQ application”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	59	India and the International Grains Council	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2024	Prelims GS-I	92	India's apple imports from the USA; GM-food import law	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	GS-III	2	Challenges to the Indian economy amid protectionism and bilateralism	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- India and the International Grains Council
- India's apple imports from the USA; GM-food import law
- Challenges to the Indian economy amid protectionism and bilateralism

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.

Answer-key rule: The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020
- **Paper(s):** GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 7

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	12	Protectionism and currency manipulation impact on macroeconomic stability	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	10	Imported edible oils versus domestic production and customs duty	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	26	Geographical Indications of Goods Act 1999 treaty compliance	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	37	Largest global rice exporter in recent years	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	84	Highest value agricultural commodity imported by India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	52	India international merchandise services trade and deficit	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	56	TRIMS trade-related investment measures WTO provisions	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Protectionism and currency manipulation impact on macroeconomic stability
- Imported edible oils versus domestic production and customs duty
- Geographical Indications of Goods Act 1999 treaty compliance
- Largest global rice exporter in recent years
- Highest value agricultural commodity imported by India
- India international merchandise services trade and deficit
- TRIMS trade-related investment measures WTO provisions

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2025 GS-III: Challenges as the world shifts from multilateral free trade to protectionism and bilateralism.
- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: IPR in life materials and why high patent filing need not become high commercialisation.
- ANALYSIS: 2026 Prelims provisional key links certification and port logistics to premium-market access and trade competitiveness.
- ANALYSIS: **IPR answer engine:** TRIPS sets a minimum-rule floor; domestic commercialisation requires viable research, technology-transfer offices, proof-of-concept finance, regulatory approval, manufacturing scale, procurement/market access and risk capital.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	12	Protectionism and currency manipulation impact on macroeconomic stability	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Protectionism and currency manipulation impact on macroeconomic stability

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III

Demand: Protectionism and currency manipulation impact on macroeconomic stability.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger; no official model answer is claimed.

Model solution: Trade-policy transmission: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome.

Merchandise and services boundary: Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. **Tariff boundary:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Protection and downstream**

competitiveness: Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Resilience versus autarky:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Trade-policy transmission: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Merchandise and services boundary:** Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. **Tariff boundary:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Protection and downstream competitiveness:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Resilience versus autarky:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Protectionism and currency manipulation impact on macroeconomic stability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger; no official model answer is claimed. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Trade-policy transmission: A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Merchandise and services boundary:** Merchandise trade records cross-border goods, while services trade follows service-supply concepts; neither should be silently substituted for total exports, imports or the broader current account. **Tariff boundary:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Protection and downstream competitiveness:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Resilience versus autarky:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-III

Demand: Challenges to the Indian economy amid protectionism and bilateralism.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger; answer uses only source-bounded categories.

Model solution: FTA legal and status boundary: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Rules of origin:** Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Trade creation and diversion:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **GVC capability conditions:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **WTO dispute-settlement status:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all

dispute settlement. **Resilience versus autarky:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive answer requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: FTA legal and status boundary: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Rules of origin: Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Trade creation and diversion:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **GVC capability conditions:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **WTO dispute-settlement status:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Resilience versus autarky:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Challenges to the Indian economy amid protectionism and bilateralism. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger; answer uses only source-bounded categories. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: FTA legal and status boundary: An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Rules of origin: Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Trade creation and diversion:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **GVC capability conditions:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **WTO dispute-settlement status:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Resilience versus autarky:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag,

causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish MFN treatment, national treatment and an FTA preference. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions.
- WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation.
- An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate

vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish MFN treatment, national treatment and an FTA preference. Answer in about 150...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or

accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish MFN treatment, national treatment and an FTA preference. Answer in about 150...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why can protection of an upstream industry reduce downstream export competitiveness? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Tariff boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input.
- Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain.
- Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Tariff boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why can protection of an upstream industry reduce downstream export competitiveness? Answer...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Tariff boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel ->

implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Tariff boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff is a customs tax on imported goods; its producer protection can coexist with higher costs for consumers and downstream firms using the import as an input. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Why can protection of an upstream industry reduce downstream export competitiveness? Answer...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Compare anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard action. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** DGTR and notification boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.
- The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** DGTR and notification boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on “Compare anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard action. Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** DGTR and notification boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** DGTR and notification boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Directorate General of Trade Remedies investigates specified Indian trade-remedy cases, but an investigation or recommendation is not the same as a final notified duty. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Compare anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard action. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Evaluate FTAs through legal status, origin rules, trade creation and trade diversion. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Rules of origin. **Named evidence/example:** Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant

institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade creation and diversion. **Named evidence/example:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses.
- Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself.
- Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Rules of origin. **Named evidence/example:** Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade creation and diversion. **Named evidence/example:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate FTAs through legal status, origin rules, trade creation and trade diversion. Answer...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Rules of origin. **Named evidence/example:** Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade creation and diversion. **Named evidence/example:** Trade creation

replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: FTA legal and status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An FTA creates preferences under agreed coverage, schedules and exceptions; signed, ratified, entered-into-force and under-negotiation are different legal statuses. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Rules of origin. **Named evidence/example:** Rules of origin determine whether a good qualifies for an FTA preference and are distinct from the preferential tariff rate itself. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade creation and diversion. **Named evidence/example:** Trade creation replaces higher-cost domestic supply with lower-cost partner supply, while trade diversion replaces a lower-cost non-member source with a higher-cost preferred partner. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag,

causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate FTAs through legal status, origin rules, trade creation and trade diversion. Answer...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: How should India respond to protectionism without moving towards indiscriminate autarky? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Trade-policy transmission. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Non-tariff measure boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Resilience versus autarky. **Named evidence/example:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome.

- A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive.
- Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain.
- Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone.
- The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement.
- Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Trade-policy transmission. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Non-tariff measure boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream export competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Resilience versus autarky. **Named evidence/example:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “How should India respond to protectionism without moving towards indiscriminate autarky?...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Trade-policy transmission. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim: Non-tariff measure boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim: Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim: GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim: WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim: Resilience versus autarky. **Named evidence/example:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel ->

implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Trade-policy transmission. **Named evidence/example:** A tariff, standard or agreement first changes landed prices and market access, then affects sourcing, investment, output, jobs and consumers; a border measure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Non-tariff measure boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A non-tariff measure may pursue a legitimate health, safety or quality objective, but its design and application determine whether it becomes discriminatory or unnecessarily trade-restrictive. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Protection and downstream competitiveness. **Named evidence/example:** Protecting an upstream input can weaken downstream export competitiveness when the input cost rises, so nominal protection must be assessed across the value chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** GVC capability conditions. **Named evidence/example:** Global value-chain participation depends on reliable logistics, customs, standards, imported inputs, finance, technology and investment predictability rather than low wages alone. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices,

distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Resilience versus autarky. **Named evidence/example:** Trade resilience diversifies suppliers, markets and capabilities; it does not require indiscriminate self-sufficiency or permanent economy-wide protection. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “How should India respond to protectionism without moving towards indiscriminate autarky?...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the WTO's continuing relevance amid weakened appellate dispute settlement. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Bound and applied tariffs. **Named evidence/example:** A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and

geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Public stockholding boundary. **Named evidence/example:** WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions.
- WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation.
- A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding.
- Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool.
- The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement.
- WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Bound and applied tariffs. **Named evidence/example:** A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Public stockholding boundary. **Named**

evidence/example: WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the WTO’s continuing relevance amid weakened appellate dispute settlement. Answer in...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Bound and applied tariffs. **Named evidence/example:** A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Trade-remedy categories. **Named evidence/example:** Anti-dumping, countervailing and safeguard actions have different legal predicates: dumping, subsidisation and serious injury from an import surge must not be treated as one generic protection tool. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** WTO dispute-settlement status. **Named evidence/example:** The WTO Appellate Body has been unable to hear new appeals since December 2019, while first-level panels and notified appeals continue; weakened appellate review is not the disappearance of all dispute settlement. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Public stockholding boundary. **Named evidence/example:** WTO agriculture rules and the interim peace-clause route for eligible public-stockholding programmes must be kept distinct from a permanent negotiated solution, which the owner records as unresolved. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
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Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: MFN treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO most-favoured-nation treatment generally requires a trade advantage granted to one member to be extended to other members, subject to agreement-specific exceptions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** National treatment. **Named evidence/example:** WTO national treatment concerns internal treatment after an imported product or service has entered the market; charging an ordinary border tariff is not by itself a national-treatment violation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Bound and applied tariffs. **Named evidence/example:** A WTO bound tariff is a negotiated ceiling, while the applied tariff is the rate actually charged; policy space exists when the applied rate remains below the binding. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base

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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the WTO's continuing relevance amid weakened appellate dispute settlement. Answer in...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.